Examination – 2024-25
Paper Title: Fiction

Time: 3 Hours *Max Marks: 75*

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. Examine the narrative technique used by Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*.
2. Write a detailed note on the major Victorian women writers.
3. Analyse the character of Fanny Price in the novel *Mansfield Park*.
4. Discuss how Charlotte Bronte's novel *Jane Eyre* challenges Victorian gender roles.
5. Discuss the theme of religion in George Eliot's novel *Middlemarch*.
6. Critically examine Charles Dickens's *Great Expectations* as a bildungsroman.
7. To what extent are the characters of the novel *The Return of the Native* responsible for their own destinies? Discuss the idea of fate in the novel.

M.A. English, Semester-II (Offline Mode)
Semester Examination 2024
Fiction
Paper Code : MEG-201

Time: 3 Hours **Max Marks : 75**

(Write your roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any five of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. Write a detailed note on the key writers of Victorian British Literature.
2. Conduct a post-colonial reading of Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe.*
3. Examine how Jane Austen has represented a contrast between urban and rural life in her novel *Mansfield Park.*
4. Discuss how Charles Dickens has explored the idea of morality in Victorian period in his novel *Great Expectations.*
5. Conduct an ecocritical analysis of Thomas Hardy's *The Return of the Native.*
6. Write character sketch of Dorothea Brooke from George Eliot's novel *Middlemarch.*
7. Analyze *Jane Eyre* by Charlotte Bronte as a Bildungsroman.
8. Write a note on the contribution of women writers to British fiction from your reading of the prescribed texts.

M·A English II-Sem (9)

(1)

Paper Code: MEG-201 Your Roll No.

M A English (ODL Mode)
Semester-II
Examination – 2024-25
Paper Title: Fiction-2

Time: 3 Hours *Max Marks: 75*

(Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. Critically examine Daniel Defoe's portrayal of the themes of postcolonialism and imperialism in his *Robinson Crusoe*.
2. Discuss in detail about the genesis and development of the genre of novel in English Literature.
3. How does Jane Austen present class distinctions and the position of women in *Mansfield Park*?
4. Examine Charlotte Bronte's *Jane Eyre* as a bildungsroman or coming-of-age novel.
5. Justify the subtitle "A Study of Provincial Life", in the novel *Middlemarch*.
6. Explore Charles Dickens's *Great Expectations* as a social critique.
7. Examine the role fate plays in the lives of the characters in Thomas Hardy's *The Return of the Native*.

M.A. English, Semester-II (Offline Mode)
Semester Examination 2024
Literary Criticism
Paper Code : MEG-202

Time: 3 Hours **Max Marks : 75**

(Write your roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any five of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. 'Organic Unity' is the essential idea of *Poetics*. Discuss.

2. Discuss the following terms from the *Poetics* in detail:
   mīmēsis
   Hamartia
   Catharsis

3. Why does Dryden give his companions (and himself) Latinate names? Why does he not use the actual names of those involved, especially given that their identities were widely known? How would the essay be different if he had used their real names?

4. Discuss "transcendental philosophy" of Coleridge in *Biographia Literaria*.

5. Discuss the role of a Critic and that of Criticism in Arnolds "The Function of Criticism at the Present Time".

6. How does "The Function of Criticism at the Present Time" represent literary criticism of the Victorian era?

7. "Tradition and the Individual Talent" is an essential text of New Criticism. Discuss.

8. Discuss the techniques and types of language Virginia Woolf uses in *A Room of One's Own*.

Code: MEG-202 Your Roll No. _____

M A English (ODL Mode)
Semester-II
Examination – 2024-25
Paper Title: Literary Criticism

Time: 3 Hours *Max Marks: 75*

(Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal

1. How does Aristotle's concept of *catharsis* function within his definition of tragedy? Discuss.
2. How does Dryden negotiate the tension between classical rules and modern innovation in drama through the dialogic structure in his *An Essay on Dramatic Poesy*?
3. How does Coleridge's distinction between *imagination* and *fancy* in *Biographia Literaria* (Chapters IV, XII, XIV) reflect his broader Romantic philosophy of creativity and poetic genius?
4. How does Arnold's notion of 'disinterestedness' shape his ideal of literary criticism, and what are its limitations in a politically charged context?
5. How does Eliot's idea of 'tradition' redefine originality, and what implications does this have for the concept of the author in modernist poetics? Discuss with reference to the essay prescribed in your syllabus.
6. How does Northrop Frye's use of Jungian archetypes and seasonal myths establish a structuralist framework for interpreting literature?
7. How does Woolf's use of the fictional narrator and narrative digression in *A Room of One's Own*challenge traditional forms of academic discourse and authority?

M.A. English, Semester-II (Offline Mode)
Semester Examination 2024
Postcolonial Literatures in English
Paper Code : MEG-203

Time: 3 Hours **Max Marks : 75**

(Write your roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any five of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. Discuss the term post-colonialism with reference to texts prescribed in your course.
2. How does Ngugiwa Thiong'o view the relationship between language, lived experience, and a people's history?
3. How does Fanon configure the relation between black and white in *Black Skin, White Masks.*
4. Write a critical analysis of the poem, "Ananse".
5. Discuss the structure and the role of the epic form in *Midnight's Children.*
6. Discuss how *Midnight's Children* can be considered a Postcolonial novel.
7. How does Adichie Portray racism in America versus racism in Nigeria in *Americanah*? Include white Americans' reaction to black Americans or Africans, as well as Nigerians' reaction to white Westerners, Asians, and other African cultures and subgroups.
8. What African/Nigerian stereotypes are depicted in *Americanah*?

Paper Code: MEG-203 (3)

Your Roll No.

M A English (ODL Mode)
Semester-II
Examination – 2024-25
Paper Title: Postcolonial Literatures in English

Time: 3 Hours *Max Marks: 75*

(Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal

1. Discuss the concept of "mental colonization" as elaborated by Ngũgĩ waThing'o and its implications for postcolonial African societies from your reading of his *Decolonizing the Minds.*
2. Explore the theme of "nationhood" in Salman Rushdie's novel *Midnight's Children.*
3. Explore the idea of human's interaction with nature in Judith Wright's poem "Rockpool".
4. Examine how Ifemelu's and Obinze's experiences reflect the challenges of identity, race, and home in a transnational context in Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie's *Americanah.*
5. Examine the theme of colonialism and its impact on the African identity in E K Braithwaite's poem "Negus".
6. What according to Franz Fanon is the role of colonial language in the life of a black man? Discuss from your reading of *Black Skin White Masks* Chapter 1.
7. Examine the salient features of Caribbean literature with special reference to E K Braithwaite's poems.

Q1. How far does *Umrao Jan Ada* achieve the literary aims of realism and cultural documentation, and where does it fall short in representing wider North Indian society of the 19th century?

Q2. In what ways does the novel *Raag Darbari* critique the failure of democratic institutions and education through the depiction of the village Shivpalganj and its inhabitants?

Q3. How does Ghalib's *Dastanbuy* reflect his complex and ambivalent position during the 1857 Revolt, especially in balancing loyalty to the British with sympathy for the suffering of Delhi and its people?

Q4. In what ways does *Stri Purush Tulana* challenge religious and cultural justifications for women's oppression, and how does Shinde's rhetorical questioning of divine justice open up space for early feminist consciousness?

Q5. Analyze how Faiz uses imagery and emotional conflict in "Don't Ask Me, for That Love Again" to represent the tension between personal affection and broader societal responsibilities.

Q6. In what ways does Mahapatra depict the "anguish of choice" faced by the rural electorate in his poem "The Election", and how does this tension reveal broader themes of power, poverty, and political agency in postcolonial India?

Q7. To what extent does *Sadgati* use irony and symbolism to critique the religious and social norms that sustain caste-based oppression?

Q8. Analyze the ways in which *Hayavadana* explores the conflict between mind and body through its characters and narrative structure.



M.A. English, Semester-II (Offline Mode)
Semester Examination 2024
Indian Literature in English Translation
Paper Code : MEG-204

Time: 3 Hours

Max Marks : 75

(Write your roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any five of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. Discuss the culture of Lucknow during the 19th Century as represented in *Umrao Jaan Ada*.

2. Comment on the writing style of Shrilal Shukla with special reference to *Raag Darbari*.

3. Discuss Mirza Ghalib's *Dastanbuy* as a historical document of the 1857 revolt.

4. How does Tarabai Shinde advocate gender equality in her essay *Stri Purush Tulana*? Discuss.

5. Discuss Faiz Ahmed Faiz as a patriotic poet. Give reference from the poems prescribed in your syllabus.

6. Is Mahashweta Devi's Draupadi a subaltern? Elucidate.

7. Discuss *Hayavadana* by Girish Karnad as an epic drama.

8. What major social issue Premchand has reflected upon in his story "Sadgati"? Discuss.

(4)

Paper Code: MEG-204

Your Roll No. _____

M A English (ODL)
Semester-II
Examination – 2024-2025
Paper Title: Indian Literatures in English Translation

Time: 3 Hours

Max Marks: 75

(Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

Q1. To what extent can Umrao Jan be seen as a self-empowered narrator rather than a victim of circumstance, and how does this tension shape our reading of the novel?

Q2. How does *Raag Darbari* use satire and dark humor to expose the deeply entrenched corruption and power dynamics in rural post-independence India?

Q3. In what ways does Ghalib's diary *Dastanbuy* use personal narrative and poetic sensibility to document the cultural devastation and human cost of the 1857 upheaval in Delhi?

Q4. How does Tarabai Shinde in *Stri Purush Tulana* critique the intertwined systems of patriarchy and caste through her comparison of the lived experiences and social treatment of men and women in 19th-century India?

Q5. In what ways does Faiz use the theme of love to reflect the tensions between personal desire and social responsibility in his poem "Don't Ask Me, for That Love Again"?

Q6. To what extent does "The Election" critique the disillusionment of Indian democracy through its portrayal of the interplay between politicians' tactics and the villagers' socio-economic realities?

Q7. Discuss how Premchand's "Sadgati" exposes the pervasive injustice of the caste system through the depiction of Dukhi's life and social context.

Q8. Examine how Karnad uses mythology and folk elements in *Hayavadana* to question the nature of identity and the search for completeness.

M.A. English, Semester-II (Offline Mode)
Semester Examination 2024
Reading Resistance Texts
Paper Code : MEG-205

Time: 3 Hours **Max Marks : 75**

(Write your roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any five of the following questions. All questions carry equal marks.

1. The introduction of *The Empire Writes Back* challenges traditional Eurocentric literary frameworks. How does it argue for the legitimacy of post-colonial texts, and what strategies do post-colonial writers employ to subvert colonial discourse?

2. How does Harlow's theoretical framework challenge traditional Western literary canons, and what role does historical context play in shaping the narratives of resistance?

3. Analyze how Javed Akhtar's "The New Decree" critiques authoritarianism and explores themes of freedom and resistance within its socio-political context.

4. Discuss how Wole Oguntokun's "The Immigrant" critiques cultural assimilation and the challenges faced by immigrants, highlighting the impact of historical and political forces on personal identity.

5. Discuss the ways in which Anjana Appachana's "Her Mother" critiques patriarchal structures and highlights the psychological impact of cultural norms on women's autonomy and identity.

6. Examine how Narayan's "Taxes for heads and breasts" critiques socio-political oppression and the commodification of human lives by exploring themes of power, gender dynamics, and economic systems.

7. Examine how Syed Shamsul Haq's 'At the Sound of Marching Feet" portrays themes of political resistance and national identity against the backdrop of South Asia's historical and socio-political landscape.

8. Discuss the ways in which Tess Lewis's 'Literature as Resistance' examines the power of narrative as a tool for dissent, focusing on how historical and political circumstances shape the act of literary resistance.

M A English (ODL Mode)
Semester-II
Examination – 2024-25
Paper Title: Reading Resistance Texts

Time: 3 Hours *Max Marks: 75*

(Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt any FIVE of the following questions. All questions carry equal

1. In what ways does literature of resistance challenge dominant narratives and power structures? Discuss with reference to the texts from your syllabus.

2. How does the concept of 'writing back' in *The Empire Writes Back* challenge the authority of canonical European literature in postcolonial contexts?

3. How does Harlow redefine the function of literature within political resistance movements in colonized or oppressed societies?

4. How does Naheed's use of gendered language and imagery in her poem "We Sinful Women" serve to critique patriarchal structures in both literature and society?

5. How does Akhtar's use of irony and allegory in his poem "The New Decree" reveal the mechanisms of authoritarianism and societal control?

6. How does Narayan critique caste and gender hierarchies through the metaphor of taxation in the short story "Taxes for Heads and Breasts"?

7. How does Haq use the motif of marching feet in his play *At the Sound of Marching Feet* to evoke both fear and resistance in the face of militarized power?